

The Mass Hlway: Fact Sheet for Patients

The Mass Hlway is a secure statewide Health Information Exchange that allows your healthcare providers to safely and quickly send your important information to where it's most needed. Doctors or nurses can care for you better when they have important information about your health. The Mass Hlway is designed to make this safer and faster. The goal is better care coordination and quality for you and your family.

What is the Mass Hlway?

- Mass Hlway is the statewide health information exchange (HIE). Healthcare providers can use the Mass Hlway to quickly and securely send and receive information to better coordinate care.
- The Mass Hlway is managed by the Commonwealth of Massachusetts' Executive Office of Health and Human Services (EOHHS).

How does the Mass Hlway protect my information?

The Mass Hlway has security measures in place to protect your true/current information better than fax, mail, or portable media like a CD or USB (flash drive), such as:

- Using a special code so that only authorized providers can read the information sent over the Mass Hlway (this is known as encrypting data).
- Establishing policies and procedures that authorize the Hlway to suspend Hlway participants as necessary to prevent unauthorized use of the Hlway.
- Overseeing who has access to the Mass Hlway and who has used it for a patient's healthcare.

How can the Mass Hlway help me?

- If you were discharged from a hospital, the Mass Hlway can be used by the hospital to send a note about your hospital stay so he or she is up to date about healthcare that you have received.
- If you get tests done, the doctor can use the Mass Hlway to send the results to other members of your healthcare team, like your specialist. This helps them coordinate care. It can also save time and money by reducing the need for repeat tests.
- If you have a chronic condition your health insurer case manager can use the Mass Hlway to communicate with your doctors and help you stay healthy.
- Not all of your healthcare providers may be using the Mass Hlway yet. There may be more benefits to you as more healthcare organizations use the Mass Hlway.

Who can use the Mass Hlway and why?

Currently the Mass Hlway may only be used by healthcare providers (like doctors' offices, hospitals, public health agencies, and health insurers). The Mass Hlway can only be used for information sharing as allowed by federal and state privacy laws. You still need to give special permission for providers to request and receive certain sensitive information. You can speak to your healthcare provider about how information is sent over the Mass Hlway.

Can I request my medical record from the Mass Hlway?

No. A patient's medical record isn't part of the Mass Hlway system. Talk to your provider for information about how to obtain your medical records.

Want more information?

Talk with your doctor or their office staff about how they are using the Mass Hlway. Visit www.masshiway.net, email us at masshiway@state.ma.us, or call us at 1-855-MA-Hlway (624-4929) and press 3.

Patient Consent for Mass Hlway

The Massachusetts Health Information Highway (Mass Hlway) is the secure statewide computer network that allows for the electronic transfer of medical information between healthcare providers that is intended to improve the quality and safety of patient care. Having received and had an opportunity to review the "Mass Hlway: Fact Sheet for Patients" provided to me by Nana G. McMahon, MD, PC, a physician practice affiliated with Emerson Health and Emerson Physician Hospital Organization (the "Practice"), I hereby give the Practice permission to use Mass Hlway to:

1. Request, send, and receive my medical information from and to my other providers who also use the Mass Hlway. I understand that this information may include information about mental health, HIV test results, sexually transmitted diseases, domestic violence, sexual assault, substance abuse records, reproductive health concerns, and genetic testing results.
2. Send to the Mass Hlway my name, date of birth, gender, email, home address, phone number, and medical record number so that my other providers using Mass Hlway know I received care from the Practice and can ask for my medical information when needed for my care.
3. I understand that I may withdraw my permission for the Practice to share information ("Opt-out") at any time by submitting a request in writing. The Opt-out notice can be sent to the Practice.

Print Patient Name

Patient Date of Birth

Signature of Patient or Patient's Legal Representative

Date of Signature

Print Name of Patient's Legal Representative (if applicable)

Relationship to Patient